DAVID J. NAJERA

ENTERPRISE TRANSFORMATION EXECUTIVE | STRATEGY & OPERATIONS | PEOPLE & ORGANIZATIONAL LEADERSHIP

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Enterprise transformation and operations executive with 29 years of global U.S. Air Force leadership across the Indo-Pacific, Europe, the Middle East, and the United States. Trusted senior advisor to executive leaders on strategy execution, organizational design, workforce and talent management, cyber and information operations, crisis response, infrastructure, resource allocation, international partnerships, and large-scale change. Career experience spans organizations and communities of up to 13,000 people, multinational and joint operations, national defense portfolios valued in the billions, and complex transitions requiring rapid alignment of people, process, technology, and mission priorities.

CORE EXECUTIVE CAPABILITIES

Enterprise Transformation • Strategy Execution • Executive Advisory • Organizational Design • Operating Model & Governance • Operational Excellence • Workforce Strategy • Talent Management • Succession Planning • Leadership Development • Change Management • Program & Project Leadership • Cybersecurity & Information Operations • Digital Transformation • Crisis & Continuity Management • Infrastructure & Resource Prioritization • Risk Management • Executive Communications • Cross-Functional Integration • International & Host-Nation Partnerships • Joint / Coalition Operations • Community & Municipal-Scale Operations

SELECTED CAREER IMPACT

- Led wing-wide integration for Operation EPIC FURY, synchronizing 3,000 personnel for the organization's first USCENTCOM combat deployment in 11 years while sustaining Indo-Pacific deterrence operations.
- Advised on operational matters affecting more than 6,000 wing personnel and 11,000 installation personnel supporting F-16, F-35, and P-8 operations in Northern Japan, including personnel from six U.S. military branches and bilateral Japanese partners.
- Institutionalized an enterprise leadership framework connecting 300 senior enlisted leaders, strengthening talent management, succession planning, onboarding, force development, accountability, and teamwork.
- Directed manpower prioritization, infrastructure, and quality-of-life investments supporting 11,000 personnel while enabling F-35 integration and optimizing bilateral U.S.-Japan resources.
- Integrated infrastructure, emergency management, public services, strategic planning, and operational requirements for a 13,000-person community in South Korea while managing a $24M infrastructure and program portfolio.
- Led emergency and evacuation planning for thousands of U.S. citizens and personnel and sustained continuity during COVID-19 and installation-wide infrastructure disruptions.
- Led a 100-person cyber and space workforce supporting $25B in national defense launch and experimental assets; redesigned the operating model supporting establishment of the U.S. Space Force and reduced staffing requirements 33% while sustaining capability.
- Led global information technology programs valued at $8B across 20 sites, improving workflow efficiency by up to 40% and negotiating technology contracts reported to deliver $12M in annual savings.
- Developed enterprise workforce and talent strategies affecting 10,000 personnel across East and Southwest Asia, connecting employee development, performance, accountability, and organizational readiness.
- Built sustained relationships with Korean governmental, civic, and military leaders and became the first enlisted member recognized as an Honorary Republic of Korea citizen for strengthening U.S.-Korean relations.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Command Chief / Senior Executive Advisor, 35th Fighter Wing

U.S. Air Force | Misawa Air Base, Japan | 2024-Present

Principal advisor to the Wing Commander on readiness, workforce effectiveness, morale, safety, resource utilization, organizational performance, and strategic execution across a complex U.S.-Japan installation.

- Lead senior enlisted integration for a wing of more than 6,000 personnel and an installation population of 11,000 supporting F-16, F-35, and P-8 operations across Northern Japan.
- Synchronized 3,000 personnel during Operation EPIC FURY, aligning operational, workforce, logistics, and strategic requirements for the wing's first USCENTCOM combat deployment in 11 years while preserving IndoPacific combat capability.
- Balanced simultaneous operational, personnel, and strategic priorities across multiple theaters, validating the organization's ability to generate combat airpower while sustaining regional deterrence.

- Unified 300 senior enlisted leaders under a deliberate leadership framework and institutionalized talent management, succession planning, force development, and leadership onboarding.
- Directed enterprise manpower prioritization, infrastructure planning, and quality-of-life investments supporting 11,000 personnel and enabling F-35 integration and worldwide contingency requirements.
- Optimized bilateral resources with Japanese partners, improving regional effectiveness without degrading ongoing operations.
- Institutionalized installation-wide governance by integrating command teams and cross-service stakeholders into a unified decision framework that reduced organizational friction and accelerated strategic execution.
- Serve as senior enlisted liaison for the fighter wing and assigned or deployed personnel from six U.S. military branches and bilateral Japanese partners.
- Advise executive leadership on organizational transformation, risk, inspection and accreditation readiness, workforce policy, strategic communications, and partner engagement.

Operations Director, Cyber & Talent Development

U.S. Air Force, 100th Communications Squadron | RAF Mildenhall, United Kingdom | 2023-2024

Senior operations and workforce leader for cyber, information, and communications capabilities supporting U.S. and allied operations across Europe.

- Directed a 300-person cyber and information operations workforce supporting approximately 3,900 personnel and geographically dispersed European operations.
- Translated complex cyber, technology, infrastructure, and operational threats into executive-level impacts, enabling faster risk decisions and prioritized system upgrades.
- Directed modernization and operational validation of expeditionary communications capabilities across multiple European locations, balancing technology investment, operational risk, and contingency-readiness requirements.
- Led network defense and information assurance activities supporting airlift and cargo operations while advising senior leaders on cybersecurity, physical security, resource procurement, and personnel training.
- Implemented data-informed performance and crisis-response practices to strengthen resilience and improve organizational visibility of technical and workforce risk.
- Supported digital transformation, technology procurement, vendor management, cybersecurity strategy, and governance of technology investments.

Senior Enlisted Leader / Executive Operations Director (Deputy Mayor / Town Manager Equivalent)

U.S. Air Force, 51st Mission Support Group | Osan Air Base, Republic of Korea | 2021-2023

Senior leader for municipal-scale installation operations, integrating infrastructure, emergency management, public services, personnel support, community programs, and operational readiness for a 13,000-person population.

- Oversaw support across 35 organizations and a diverse installation population, aligning facilities, workforce, community services, and operational requirements.
- Managed and prioritized a $24M infrastructure and program portfolio to address community needs, failing infrastructure, and mission requirements.
- Propelled the Dorm Divestment Initiative, reducing failing infrastructure across 14 buildings and improving living conditions for the 13,000-person installation community.
- Led emergency-action and continuity planning during installation-wide power disruptions and other crises, protecting personnel and establishing longer-term infrastructure resilience measures.
- Directed noncombatant evacuation and crisis-response planning affecting thousands of U.S. citizens, families, and personnel in a high-tempo overseas environment.
- Augmented fighter wing senior enlisted leadership during five wartime exercises, facilitating realistic combat operations and support for a forward-deployed wing of approximately 5,600 personnel.
- Selected as an Airman Leadership School mentor and facilitated an eight-week officer/enlisted leadership pathway seminar, expanding leadership development for 98 Airmen.
- Strengthened U.S.-Republic of Korea governmental, military, civic, and sister-city relationships throughout the pandemic; recognized as the first enlisted member awarded Honorary Republic of Korea citizenship.
- Rated #3 of 19 assigned Chief Master Sergeants and assessed 'Ready Now' for Command Chief responsibility in the 2021-2022 performance cycle.

Chief Operations Superintendent, Mobility & Operations Support

U.S. Air Force | Fort Bragg, North Carolina | 2020-2021

Integrated Air Force and Army organizations supporting global special-operations quick-reaction forces and worldwide mobility requirements.

- Coordinated cross-service operations supporting 2,500 personnel and global special-operations quick-reaction requirements.
- Directed aerial port, transportation, freight, and deployment logistics that moved 36 tons of mission-essential equipment and 65 operators in support of national security objectives.
- Designed 24/7 shift, quarantine, and continuity-of-operations measures during COVID-19, preserving uninterrupted air-mobility cargo and personnel deployment despite workforce constraints.
- Integrated readiness, logistics, personnel, and operational support across joint organizations to sustain rapid global response.

Chief, Space & Cyber Operations

U.S. Air Force | Vandenberg Air Force Base, California | 2017-2020

Senior operations leader for cyber, space launch, workforce, and joint-service support across nationally significant space and experimental missions.

- Led a 100-person cyber and space workforce supporting and safeguarding $25B in national defense launch, experimental, and related mission assets.
- Established foundational organizational and operating structures supporting creation of the U.S. Space Force under U.S. Space Command.
- Redesigned workforce and operating models to reduce staffing requirements 33% while maintaining full mission capability.
- Managed joint-service personnel operations and a $1.8M budget supporting cyber defense, space launch, and operational effectiveness.
- Directed operational and personnel support for approximately 2,500 personnel across multiple nationwide space launch and operations locations.
- Implemented performance monitoring, workforce development, and crisis-response strategies to strengthen cyber and space resilience and continuity for high-demand, low-density capabilities.
- Supported onboarding and orientation programs serving thousands of personnel annually, improving organizational integration and readiness.

Human Capital, Talent Development & Organizational Performance Leadership

U.S. Air Force | Kadena Air Base, Japan / Al Udeid Air Base, Qatar and other locations | 2011-2017

Progressive senior leadership roles focused on workforce strategy, quality assurance, employee development, performance management, contingency operations, and organizational readiness.

- Developed enterprise workforce quality, accountability, and talent strategies affecting approximately 10,000 personnel across East and Southwest Asia.
- Designed and executed leadership development, professional education, succession, and performance improvement initiatives linking individual growth to organizational requirements.
- Used quality assurance and performance systems to strengthen production, discipline, readiness, and organizational capability.
- Directed workforce and contingency-response actions during global deployments, protecting personnel and maintaining operational continuity in high-risk environments.
- Built cross-functional and multinational relationships across Japan, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, and other partner environments to improve workforce and mission integration.

Information Management, Technology & Administrative Operations Leadership

U.S. Air Force | United States, United Kingdom, South Korea, Saudi Arabia and other global locations | 1997-2011 Progressed through information management, technology, administrative operations, and supervisory roles supporting global Air Force organizations.

- Led global IT programs reported at $8B across 20 sites, redesigning workflows and digital processes to improve operational efficiency by 30-40%.
- Negotiated technology and vendor agreements reported to deliver $12M in annual savings.
- Implemented digital and paperless workflow systems that reduced administrative turnaround time and improved service delivery, reliability, organizational agility, and access to information.
- Managed information assurance, records, executive support, administrative processes, and technology-enabled operations in geographically dispersed organizations.
- Built foundational expertise in customer service, personnel support, process improvement, information management, technology operations, and front-line leadership that enabled progression into enterprise executive roles.

SELECTED LEADERSHIP, TRANSFORMATION & PROGRAM PORTFOLIO

Enterprise Governance & Operating Model: Designed cross-functional decision structures connecting executive teams, command teams, senior enlisted leaders, and multi-service stakeholders to improve visibility, accountability, coordination, and execution.

F-35 / Fighter Integration: Aligned manpower, infrastructure, quality-of-life, logistics, workforce, and bilateral partner requirements supporting fifth-generation fighter integration while sustaining existing F-16 and regional operations.
Operation EPIC FURY: Integrated 3,000 personnel and enterprise requirements for a major combat deployment, balancing concurrent theater, workforce, logistics, and strategic demands.
Space Force Organizational Design: Helped establish foundational operating structures for the emerging U.S. Space Force and redesigned staffing to reduce requirements by 33% without loss of mission capability.
Cyber & Digital Modernization: Led cyber and information operations, expeditionary communications modernization, technology risk translation, procurement advice, and digital workflow transformation across U.S.
and European operations.
Municipal / Installation Management: Integrated facilities, infrastructure, emergency management, public services, community programs, and mission support for a 13,000-person overseas community.
Crisis & Continuity Leadership: Led or supported COVID-19 continuity, evacuation exercises, power-outage response, rapid deployment, wartime exercises, and contingency operations while maintaining mission execution.
Talent & Succession Strategy: Institutionalized leadership pipelines, mentoring, onboarding, succession planning, workforce accountability, performance improvement, and professional development at scales from 98 emerging leaders to 10,000-person enterprises.
International Partnerships: Built operational and civic relationships with Japanese, Korean, British, Saudi, U.S., and allied stakeholders, improving interoperability, shared problem solving, and regional effectiveness.

EXECUTIVE COMMUNICATIONS & ADVISORY EXPERIENCE

- Prepare and deliver executive briefings, strategic plans, decision analyses, policy recommendations, and organizational performance assessments for senior military and civilian leaders.
- Translate complex operational, cyber, workforce, infrastructure, and risk information into decision-ready recommendations for executive leaders.
- Advise on workforce policy, resource allocation, organizational design, leadership succession, crisis response, readiness, partner engagement, and strategic communications.
- Operate routinely in high-discretion, high-pressure environments requiring diplomacy, judgment, cross-cultural awareness, and rapid synthesis of incomplete information.

EDUCATION

- M.S., Business Management, Western Governors University, 2025
- B.S., General Studies, University of Management & Technology, 2015
- A.A.S., Human Resources Management, Community College of the Air Force, 2012
- A.A.S., Information Management, Community College of the Air Force, 2001

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

• Google Project Management Professional Certification • DEOMI Mediation Certification • Professional Management Certification • CompTIA Security+ Certification • CompTIA A+ Certification • Grief Recovery Method Specialist Certification

SELECTED RECOGNITION

- 2026: Assessed 'Ready Now' for Tier 2 Command Chief responsibility; senior reviewer cited leadership during Operation EPIC FURY, F-35 integration, and enterprise transformation.
- 2022: Rated #3 of 19 assigned Chief Master Sergeants and assessed 'Ready Now' for Command Chief responsibility.
- Recognized as the first enlisted member awarded Honorary Republic of Korea citizenship for advancing U.S. Korean relationships and community partnership.
- Selected for senior leadership, mentoring, and professional military education roles throughout the career, including Airman Leadership School mentorship and officer/enlisted leadership development.

GLOBAL & FUNCTIONAL EXPERIENCE

Locations and partner environments include Japan, Republic of Korea, United Kingdom, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, continental United States, and broader Indo-Pacific, European, and Middle Eastern operations. Functional exposure includes fighter aviation, mobility, special operations support, space launch, cyber and information operations, human capital, infrastructure, emergency management, community services, logistics, medical support integration, public-sector administration, executive governance, and multinational defense cooperation.